

Absolutely — **mouth** is a strong polysemy target because your passage uses it inside the fixed expression:

> “Secondly, it benefits from **word of mouth**.”

Here **mouth** does **not** refer literally to the body part. In **word of mouth**, it refers figuratively to **information or recommendations passed directly from person to person through conversation**.

Word family: **mouth / mouthed / mouthing / mouthful / mouthpiece**

Base word: mouth

Plural: mouths

Verb forms: mouth, mouths, mouthed, mouthing

Related forms: mouthful, mouthpiece

Part of speech: noun (名詞) / verb (動詞)

Pronunciation note:

* noun **mouth** /maʊθ/

* plural **mouths** commonly /maʊðz/

* verb **mouth** /maʊð/

So the **th** sound can change between noun and verb.

Meaning in your passage: **word of mouth = 口碑 ; 口耳相傳**

Your sentence:

> “It benefits from **word of mouth**.”

Here **word of mouth** means:

> **information, opinions, or recommendations that spread informally from one person to another through conversation rather than through paid advertising.**

繁體中文 :

人們透過交談、推薦和口耳相傳，自然把資訊或評價傳給其他人；口碑 / 口耳相傳

Natural translation:

> “It benefits from word of mouth.”

「它很受惠於**口碑傳播**。」

So here:

> **word of mouth = 口碑；口耳相傳**

1. **mouth = the opening in the face used for eating, speaking, breathing — 嘴；口**

The core literal meaning.

Practice 1

> “She covered her **mouth** when she laughed.”

「她笑的時候用手掩住**嘴巴**。」

Practice 2

> “Open your mouth.”

「張開你的**嘴**。」

mouth = 人或動物臉上用來進食、說話和呼吸的開口

2. **mouth = lips / oral area in expressions — 嘴部；口部**

A closely related physical use.

Practice 3

> “There was chocolate around his **mouth**.”

「他的**嘴邊**沾了朱古力。」

Practice 4

> “She wiped her mouth with a napkin.”

「她用餐巾擦了擦**嘴**。」

mouth = 嘴巴及其周圍口部區域

This belongs to the same physical sense, so I would not split it heavily.

3. **mouth = opening of a river — 河口**

A major geographical meaning.

Practice 5

> “The village lies near the **mouth of the river**.”

「這條村位於**河口**附近。」

Practice 6

> “The river widens near its mouth.”

「河流接近**河口**時變寬。」

mouth — geography = 河流流入海、湖或另一條河的出口位置

This is a genuine lexical extension based on the idea of an opening.

4. **mouth = opening of a cave/container/etc. — 洞口；入口；開口**

A broader physical extension.

Practice 7

> “They stood at the **mouth of the cave**.”

「他們站在**洞口**。」

Practice 8

> “Smoke came from the mouth of the tunnel.”

「煙從隧道的**入口 / 洞口**冒出來。」

mouth = 洞穴、隧道、容器等的開口處

Same conceptual extension:

> body opening → object opening

5. **mouth = person being fed / dependent person — 一張嘴；需供養的人**

A figurative countable use.

Practice 9

> “They had five **mouths to feed**.”

「他們有五**口人要養**。」

Practice 10

> “Another child meant another mouth to feed.”

「多一個孩子就代表多一**口人要供養**。」

mouth = 需要吃飯、需要被供養的人

Common in:

> mouths to feed

6. **mouth = way of speaking / outspoken speech — 嘴；說話方式**

A figurative use in expressions.

Practice 11

> “He has a big **mouth**.”

「他很**多嘴 / 口沒遮攔**。」

Practice 12

> “Watch your mouth.”

「說話注意一點 / **嘴巴放乾淨點**。」

mouth = 一個人說話、洩密、粗魯發言等的方式

Often idiomatic rather than a new core sense.

7. **word of mouth = 口碑；口耳相傳**

This is your exact source expression.

Practice 13 — Original

> “The bakery benefits from **word of mouth**.”

「這間麵包店很受惠於**口碑傳播**。」

Practice 14

> “Most of their new customers come through word of mouth.”

「他們大部分新顧客都是靠**口耳相傳**而來。」

word of mouth = 人與人直接透過交談、推薦而傳播資訊 / 評價

8. **by word of mouth = 透過口耳相傳**

Practice 15

> “The event became popular **by word of mouth**.”

「這個活動靠**口耳相傳**而變得受歡迎。」

Practice 16

> “News of the bakery spread by word of mouth.”

「這間麵包店的消息透過**口碑**傳開。」

by word of mouth = 透過人與人非正式口頭傳播

9. **mouth = verb, form words silently — 用嘴形說；只做口型**

A major verb sense.

Practice 17

> “She ****mouthed**** ‘thank you’ across the room.”

「她隔著房間用****口型說****『謝謝』。」

Practice 18

> “He mouthed the words without making a sound.”

「他沒有發出聲音，只是****做出口型****。」

****mouth — verb = 用嘴唇形成字詞，但不真正發聲或聲音很小****

10. ****mouth = verb, say words mechanically / without sincerity — 機械地說；空泛地說****

A figurative verb use.

Practice 19

> “He ****mouthed**** the usual excuses.”

「他只是****機械式地說出****那些老套藉口。」

Practice 20

> “Politicians often mouth familiar slogans.”

「政客常常只是****重複說著****熟悉的口號。」

****mouth = 把話說出口，但可能缺乏真誠、理解或實際行動****

Often mildly negative.

11. ****mouthful = amount that fills the mouth — 一口；滿嘴的量****

A useful family extension.

Practice 21

> “He took a ****mouthful**** of coffee.”

「他喝了一****大口咖啡****。」

Practice 22

> “She spoke with a mouthful of cake.”

「她嘴裡塞著一**大口蛋糕**還在說話。」

mouthful = 一次放入口中 / 能填滿口腔的食物或飲料量

12. **mouthful = very long/difficult word or phrase — 又長又難念的一串字**

A figurative extension.

Practice 23

> “That company name is a real **mouthful**.”

「那個公司名稱真是**又長又難念**。」

Practice 24

> “The scientific term is quite a mouthful.”

「那個科學術語真是**一大串，難念得很**。」

a mouthful = 長、複雜、難以順口說出的名稱 / 短語

13. **mouthpiece = device placed at/near the mouth — 吹嘴；話筒口；咬嘴**

A physical family extension.

Practice 25

> “The musician cleaned the instrument’s **mouthpiece**.”

「音樂家清潔了樂器的**吹嘴**。」

Practice 26

> “The snorkel has a soft mouthpiece.”

「浮潛呼吸管有一個柔軟的**咬嘴**。」

****mouthpiece = 放在嘴邊 / 口中的裝置部件****

14. ****mouthpiece = spokesperson / person who speaks for others — 代言人；傳聲筒****

A major figurative extension.

Practice 27

> “The newspaper became a ****mouthpiece**** for the organization.”

「這份報紙成為那個組織的****傳聲筒****。」

Practice 28

> “He was seen as a mouthpiece for the industry.”

「他被視為業界的****代言人 / 傳聲筒****。」

****mouthpiece — figurative = 代表某人 / 組織發聲，或替其宣傳觀點的人 / 媒體****

This can be neutral or critical depending on context.

15. ****mouth-watering = 令人垂涎的；非常誘人的****

A very common compound.

Practice 29

> “The bakery displayed ****mouth-watering**** cakes.”

「麵包店展示了令人****垂涎欲滴****的蛋糕。」

Practice 30

> “The smell was absolutely mouth-watering.”

「那股香味簡直令人****垂涎三尺****。」

****mouth-watering = 好吃 / 好聞到令人分泌口水；非常誘人的****

Directly relevant to your bakery passage.

16. **mouth-watering = extremely attractive/desirable figuratively — 非常誘人的**

A broader figurative extension.

Practice 31

> “The deal offered a **mouth-watering** profit.”

「這宗交易提供了非常**誘人的利潤**。」

Practice 32

> “The team received a mouth-watering offer.”

「團隊收到了一個非常**吸引人的報價**。」

mouth-watering — figurative = 好得令人非常想得到的

17. **mouth-to-mouth = 人工呼吸 (口對口) **

A useful fixed compound.

Practice 33

> “He was given **mouth-to-mouth**.”

「有人為他進行了**口對口人工呼吸**。」

Practice 34

> “The first-aid course covered mouth-to-mouth resuscitation.”

「急救課程包括**口對口人工呼吸**。」

mouth-to-mouth = 透過口對口吹氣進行人工呼吸

Important distinction: **mouth vs lips**

mouth

= whole oral opening/area.

lips

= outer fleshy edges of the mouth.

> open your mouth

> = 張嘴

> bite your lip

> = 咬嘴唇

Not interchangeable.

Important distinction: **mouth vs oral**

mouth

everyday noun.

oral

formal adjective relating to the mouth or spoken communication.

> mouth infection

> = 口腔感染

> oral health

> = 口腔健康

Important distinction: **mouth vs opening**

mouth

can metaphorically name a natural/opening part:

* river mouth

* cave mouth

opening

generic term for any gap/entrance.

So:

> mouth adds a more specific lexicalized image.

Important distinction: **word of mouth vs advertising**

word of mouth

= recommendations passed naturally person to person.

advertising

= paid/planned promotion.

Your passage emphasizes that Golden Crust succeeds partly without relying only on formal advertising.

Important distinction: **word of mouth vs reputation**

You already mapped **reputation**.

word of mouth

= the process/channel through which people talk and recommend.

reputation

= the overall opinion people have formed.

So:

> good word of mouth

> can help build

> a strong reputation.

Different concepts.

Important distinction: **word of mouth vs review**

word of mouth

usually informal person-to-person recommendation.

review

a more explicit evaluation, often written or posted online.

A review can contribute to word of mouth, especially digitally, but they are not identical.

Important distinction: **mouth — noun vs verb**

Noun:

> “Open your mouth.”

= 張嘴。

Verb:

> “She mouthed the words.”

= 她只做出口型。

Same spelling, different pronunciation and grammar.

Important distinction: **mouth / mouths pronunciation**

Useful pronunciation note:

Noun singular

> mouth /maʊθ/

Noun plural

> mouths /maʊðz/ commonly

Verb

> mouth /maʊð/

This is a nice pronunciation-shift target.

Important distinction: **mouthful vs bite**

mouthful

= quantity filling the mouth.

bite

= amount taken by biting.

> a mouthful of coffee

> = 一大口咖啡

> a bite of cake

> = 一口咬下的蛋糕

Different mechanism.

Important distinction: **mouthpiece — literal vs figurative**

Literal:

> instrument mouthpiece

> = 樂器吹嘴

Figurative:

> political mouthpiece

> = 政治傳聲筒 / 代言人

Excellent MCQ contrast.

Important distinction: **mouth-watering vs delicious**

delicious

= tastes very good.

mouth-watering

= looks/smells so appealing that it makes you want to eat it.

So:

> mouth-watering can describe food before you have tasted it.

Important note on polysemy depth

Mouth has a genuinely rich but manageable inventory:

1. body part
2. opening of river/cave etc.
3. dependent person in “mouths to feed”
4. speech-related idioms
5. verb: silently form words / say mechanically
6. family extensions:

- * mouthful
- * mouthpiece
- * mouth-watering

The source **word of mouth** is idiomatic but essential, so it belongs in the entry despite the normal no-phrasal-verb rule.

Family-extension sweep

After the full audit, the useful modern inventory includes:

- * **mouth — body part** = 嘴 / 口
- * **mouth — opening** = 河口 / 洞口 / 入口
- * **mouth — dependent person** = 一口人 / 需供養的人
- * **word of mouth** = 口碑 / 口耳相傳
- * **mouth — verb: silent speech** = 做口型
- * **mouth — verb: empty/rehearsed speech** = 機械 / 空泛地說
- * **mouthful — quantity** = 一大口
- * **mouthful — difficult phrase** = 又長又難念的一串字
- * **mouthpiece — device** = 吹嘴 / 咬嘴
- * **mouthpiece — spokesperson** = 代言人 / 傳聲筒
- * **mouth-watering — food** = 令人垂涎的

* **mouth-watering — figurative** = 非常誘人的

* **mouth-to-mouth** = 口對口人工呼吸

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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mouth — body	人或動物臉上用來進食、說話及呼吸的開口
mouth — river/cave etc.	河流、洞穴、隧道等的出口 / 開口位置
mouth — dependent person	需要吃飯、需要被供養的一個人
word of mouth	人與人透過交談、推薦而自然傳播資訊或評價
mouth — verb: silent	用嘴唇形成字詞但不真正發聲
mouth — verb: insincere	機械 / 空泛地把某些說法或口號說出口
mouthful — quantity	一次能放入口中或填滿口腔的一份量
mouthful — phrase	長、複雜、難以順口說出的詞語 / 名稱
mouthpiece — device	放在嘴邊 / 口中的裝置部件
mouthpiece — figurative	代表某人 / 組織發聲或宣傳其觀點的人 / 媒體
mouth-watering	好吃 / 好聞到令人垂涎；或比喻非常誘人的
mouth-to-mouth	口對口人工呼吸

For your original phrase

> “Secondly, it benefits from **word of mouth**.”

The exact meaning is:

**word of mouth = 顧客吃過後覺得不錯，便直接向朋友、同事、鄰居推薦，令 Golden Crust 的名聲自然在人與人之間傳開。*

Natural translation:

> **「第二，它很受口碑傳播帶動。」*

The highest-value contrasts are:

- > **mouth** → 嘴 / 口
- > **river mouth** → 河口
- > **mouth of a cave** → 洞口
- > **mouths to feed** → 要供養的人口
- > **word of mouth** → 口碑 / 口耳相傳
- > **mouth words silently** → 只做口型
- > **mouthful** → 一大口 / 難念的一串字
- > **mouthpiece** → 吹嘴 / 傳聲筒
- > **mouth-watering** → 令人垂涎 / 非常誘人的